Jensen Huang Would Have Got Away With It if He Did THIS

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 13, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qP6KOb7niXo Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Jensen Huang's downfall illustrates a timeless principle: projecting a perfect image and then getting exposed creates far more backlash than owning your flaws openly from the start. Be Charlie Sheen, not Tiger Woods.

📑 Contents

- 🏢 Jensen Huang's Fall From Grace
- ⚖️ The Charlie Sheen vs. Tiger Woods Contrast
- 📖 Robert Greene's Law 46: Never Appear Too Perfect
- 🧪 The Science Behind the "Pratfall Effect"
- 🛠️ How to Apply This in Your Own Life
- 🧠 Why Authenticity Protects Your Mental Health

🏢 Jensen Huang's Fall From Grace 0:00

- Jensen Huang, CEO of a **$4.5 trillion company** (Nvidia), admitted to having an affair roughly four days before this video was recorded
  - He initially survived the first affair revelation but reports soon emerged of additional affairs
  - A third affair was reported, which ultimately forced his resignation
- The affair partner in at least one case was allegedly a spy, adding a national-security dimension
- Carter notes that the spy angle was part of the problem but argues it isn't the whole explanation
- Comparison to Elon Musk: Musk faces similar or worse allegations — fathering children frequently, **Wall Street Journal reports of ketamine use in the office during his DOGE tenure** — yet faces virtually no career consequences
  - Carter uses this contrast as the central question driving the video: why does the same behavior ruin one person and roll off another?

⚖️ The Charlie Sheen vs. Tiger Woods Contrast 1:10

- **Tiger Woods (2009):** Crashed his SUV outside his home on Thanksgiving; wife allegedly chased him with a golf club; affairs with porn stars and escorts became public
  - Lost between **$25 million and $50 million per year** in endorsements

- Shareholders in his affiliated businesses lost between **$5 billion and $12 billion**
- Divorce losses were on top of these figures
- His golf game deteriorated for roughly a decade afterward

- **Charlie Sheen (2010):** Was the **highest-paid television actor in history at $1.8 million per episode**
  - Was caught in a hotel room with hookers and cocaine — no firing
  - He was eventually fired, but only for **talking trash about his employer**, not for the drug and sex scandals
  - Continued earning approximately **$40 million per year** throughout the scandals
- The core difference: Tiger had a meticulously crafted clean-cut, disciplined family-man image; Charlie had an established bad-boy, "I don't care" persona
  - Tiger's behavior shattered expectations; Charlie's behavior confirmed them

📖 Robert Greene's Law 46: Never Appear Too Perfect 2:44

- Carter references **48 Laws of Power by Robert Greene**, specifically **Law 46: Never Appear Too Perfect**
  - Greene advises occasionally displaying your defects and shortcomings to come across as more human and approachable
  - Projecting perfection creates envy, and envy breeds silent enemies
- Greene traces this back to **ancient Athens**: a politician universally regarded as honest — never stole, never did wrong — was eventually **exiled by the entire city**
  - The city resented his perfection
- Carter's interpretation: people don't dislike flaws; they dislike being lied to or misled
  - Jensen Huang had **33 years of zero public drama or scandal**, described as being on a pedestal with a compelling rags-to-riches story (busboy at Denny's → builder of one of the largest companies in history)
  - When the truth emerged, the gap between image and reality triggered intense public resentment
- Elon Musk's "nerd rebel" reputation means his controversies land as confirmation, not betrayal — people react with "ah, yeah, that's just Elon"

> The public doesn't punish you for your flaws. They punish you for hiding them and pretending to be something you're not.

- Fitness industry analogy: a YouTuber who claimed to be natural and is later found to be on steroids faces scandal; a YouTuber who built their channel around openly discussing PEDs faces none
  - Carter applied this personally: when he started **TRT (testosterone replacement therapy) in his 40s**, he made full YouTube documentaries about it, showed blood work, and interviewed his doctors multiple times
  - When he started **peptides**, he documented the entire journey from the beginning
  - His reasoning: "I didn't want anyone to think I was claiming to be natural once I stopped being natural"

🧪 The Science Behind the "Pratfall Effect" 5:46

- A **1966 psychology study** tested how mistakes affect likability
  - Subjects listened to recordings of a person trying out for a college quiz team
  - One version: the candidate was a genius; the other: he was average
  - In both versions, the candidate spilled coffee (a minor blunder)
  - **Result:** People liked the genius MORE after he spilled the coffee, but liked the average person LESS after the same mistake
- Key takeaway: the "pratfall effect" only works if you are already perceived as highly competent
  - Showing a harmless flaw on top of demonstrated excellence makes you more likable
  - Showing the same flaw when you haven't established competence makes you look worse

🛠️ How to Apply This in Your Own Life 6:51

- **Step 1 — Show your flaws proactively**
  - Resist the tendency to project a perfect, mistake-free image
  - Carter's personal example: he has dyslexia, diagnosed as a child, and openly discusses it
    - If viewers see him misspell a word, the context is already set: "Oh, that's just Brandon, his brain works differently"
    - Without that disclosure, the same misspelling would read as fraud or incompetence
- **Step 2 — Be radically transparent**
  - Don't wait to be found out; disclose proactively and in detail
  - Carter's TRT example: made long-form YouTube documentaries, showed blood work, interviewed doctors — because being discovered quietly would have felt like cheating
  - He notes every man's natural testosterone begins declining around age 30, and he frames TRT as a smart health decision for men in their 40s
  - Transparency creates community: older men who were ashamed of being on TRT told Carter he "made it normal" for them; some men were having testosterone delivered to their workplace to hide it from their wives
  - Carter's approach: injected testosterone in front of his girlfriend during a casual post-breakfast conversation — no secrecy even at home
- **Step 3 — Fully own it**
  - Don't just disclose; embrace and lean into your real identity
  - Carter argues that if Tiger Woods had cultivated a genuine bad-boy brand, he might have lost some family-friendly endorsements but gained others (e.g., Monster Energy)
  - Charlie Sheen was, in Carter's words, "a dope fiend whoremonger" — and was the highest-paid actor on television **because** that was authentically his brand
  - On Jensen: the spy element might still have been a problem, but if he had lived openly like Elon from the start, the affairs alone likely wouldn't have ended his career

- **Privacy is effectively dead** — Carter argues that keeping secrets is no longer viable
  - "Maybe 10 years ago you could have kept secrets. Those days are over."
  - In an era of total information exposure, owning your truth preemptively is the only sustainable strategy

🧠 Why Authenticity Protects Your Mental Health 10:22

- Pretending to be someone else and gaining approval for that false persona is psychologically corrosive
  - People end up liking the facade, not the real person — which provides no genuine validation
- Fame and public life expose people to criticism at a scale humans never evolved to handle
  - For most of human history, people lived in **tribes of 150–200 people**
  - Being ostracized from the tribe likely meant death (exposure, attack by rival tribes or animals)
  - Evolution therefore hardwired humans to deeply care about social approval — "we evolved to give a [damn] for a reason"
  - People who say "I don't care what people think" misunderstand human biology and evolution
- When internet-scale criticism hits, **self-esteem built on authenticity is the only real buffer**
  - Carter notes Greg Doucette (a large fitness YouTuber) spent roughly two years making ~5 videos per year criticizing him, sending waves of hostile commenters to his page
  - Carter could handle it because he genuinely likes himself and his public persona matches his private one
- The things that hurt most are the things you're already insecure about
  - Carter's example: being called a "tiny Chinese woman" — shrugs it off
  - Being told his calves look small — stings, because that's his acknowledged weak point (he does **8 sets of calf raises per day** because of it)
  - Being told he has no money — ignores it confidently because he is secure in his finances
- If you're faking an identity, you can't fully like yourself, because you're hiding your real self for a reason — implying you're not proud of it
  - Carter believes this psychological toll contributed to Tiger Woods's decade-long performance slump after the scandal
- Final prescription: **own your flaws, put them on display, lean into who you actually are**
  - "You'd rather be Charlie Sheen than Tiger Woods. You'd rather be Elon Musk than Jensen Huang. You'd rather be yourself than a pretend version."